MVPCompanion

RESOURCE 3.3

Readiness Checklist

Use this checklist to review whether the essential MVP definition decisions are clear enough to hand over for design, estimation, or implementation.

PROJECT / APP NAME _____ **REVIEW DATE** _____

1. Problem, User & Value

- [ ] The problem is described independently of a proposed solution.
- [ ] The primary user and relevant non-target groups are explicit.
- [ ] The usage context, current alternatives, and workarounds are understood.
- [ ] The desired user outcome and value proposition are clear.
- [ ] Evidence, hypotheses, derived conclusions, and open questions are distinguished (E/H/D/O).

2. Product, Jobs & Scope

- [ ] The product concept, central entities, and relevant lifecycle are described.
- [ ] The prioritized Core Jobs are expressed as user outcomes, not UI features.
- [ ] The selected capabilities are traceable to Core Jobs.
- [ ] Must Have, Should Have, Later, and Not in MVP are distinguished and justified.
- [ ] The MVP supports a coherent end-to-end core journey.

Readiness Checklist · Continued

Review experience, information, data, requirements, learning, and technical constraints.

3. Experience, Information & Data

- [ ] The core user flow, entry point, and first moment of value are described.
- [ ] Important states, errors, exceptions, and recovery paths are considered.
- [ ] Information architecture and navigation support findability and comprehension.
- [ ] The Data Model identifies relevant entities, attributes, relationships, and lifecycle.
- [ ] Privacy, access, data quality, and retention considerations are visible where relevant.

4. Requirements & Verification

- [ ] Requirements describe observable product behavior, inputs, outputs, and dependencies.
- [ ] Acceptance criteria are specific enough to verify.
- [ ] Important boundary cases and failure conditions are addressed.
- [ ] The traceability chain is coherent: Problem → User → Outcome → Job → Capability → Requirement → Acceptance Criterion → Metric.

5. Learning & Technical Boundaries

- [ ] Key learning questions and hypotheses are explicit.
- [ ] Experiments, success signals, metrics, and decision rules are defined where possible.
- [ ] Technical constraints, integrations, dependencies, and major risks are visible.
- [ ] Open questions and decisions that could change scope are documented.
- [ ] Market Discovery and Business Model considerations remain visible as cross-cutting workstreams.

Final Gate & Handoff

Confirm the MVP boundary, record unresolved issues, and make an explicit readiness decision.

6. MVP Boundary & Handoff

- [ ] The MVP boundary explains the smallest coherent product that delivers core value and supports learning.
- [ ] Explicit exclusions are recorded with rationale.
- [ ] The specification is internally consistent and does not contradict earlier decisions.
- [ ] The remaining uncertainties are acceptable for the next step—or have owners and resolution plans.
- [ ] The specification is the integrated result of the 15 stages, not an additional stage.

Readiness decision

Current decision: Select...

Conditions / unresolved issues and owners

Next action and review date

Remember: readiness is a judgment about clarity and risk—not a guarantee of success.